

start saving and investing, you will never have enough of what you want. Another way to generate a sense of having “enough” is to cultivate gratitude for what you *do* have. This often comes naturally to people as they age, because they start to gain perspective. The things they thought were important when they were young just aren’t that important anymore. They begin to feel gratitude for the things they do have, for the life they live, and for the time they can keep on living. I see that “attitude of gratitude” in people I admire—in my stepfather, George, and certainly in my mother when she was alive.

My parents weren’t wealthy just in terms of money. They had a wealth of experience, a wealth of friends, and a wealth of love. And when I listened to those people in Debtors Anonymous, the ones on the road to financial recovery, they all had that same “attitude of gratitude” in common. There they were, broke and starting from scratch again, and yet they exuded hope. And by trying to help each other, they were taking the first steps toward real financial change.

The best part about getting older is this: If you’ve lived a full life, if you’ve made mistakes and learned from them, and if you’re lucky enough to surround yourself with people who really know you and love you, something magical happens—material things no longer matter as much. What does begin to matter are the things in life that are free—things like love, respect, and integrity—and no amount of money can buy you those.